

such as YouTube and Gametrailers. Well, whatever the nature of the game, it is definitely another gem to look out for.

F.E.A.R. 2: Project Origin (Xbox 360, PS3, PC)

The nightmare has returned, Alma Wade is back. The sequel to *F.E.A.R.* continues the supernatural suspense story of Alma, a powerful psychic who rages against those who wronged her. This triggers an escalating paranormal crisis in her person, that threatens to devour and replace the reality as we know it, with her own. Her story is told in *F.E.A.R.* through various means such as sequenced flashbacks, snip-pets of CCTV footage, and other evidence found playing the game. In *Project Origin*, you will encounter Alma, we assume, in a similar way they did in the first game — through exploration of a city that was annihilated by the cataclysmic explosion of the previous game. This time you will not be playing as the Point Man, but will instead play a special forces operator called Michael Becket, whose squad is sent in to arrest Genevieve Aristide, based on the evidence gathered against her by the Point Man in *F.E.A.R.* All of this will be occurring 30 minutes prior to the ending of *F.E.A.R.* The game's teaser throws some great fight sequences and some chilling moments. We can't wait. Visit <http://projectorigin.warnerbros.com> to learn more about this game. *This just in: at the time of writing this, Project Origin's demo has been released on the PC and console platforms. So what are you waiting for, go grab it!*



Diablo III (PC, Mac OS X)

Diablo III is another sequel to a very popular RPG series from Blizzard. The game offers a new story-line and of course, awesome graphics. *Diablo III* takes place in Sanctuary, the dark fantasy world of the *Diablo* series. For those of you who played *Diablo II*, the world was saved by a handful of unnamed heroes. The story goes like this: the warriors that survived the onslaught of the armies of the Burning Hells have gone mad from their ordeals, and it is up to a new generation of heroes to face the forces of evil threatening the world of Sanctuary. Players will also have the opportunity to explore familiar settings such as Tristram. The three classes which have been revealed so far are the Barbarian, the Wizard and the Witch Doctor. The Barbarian is the one class that has been preserved from *Diablo II*. A scary fact about the Wizard has been mentioned as on the *Diablo III* website: "Imagine, a



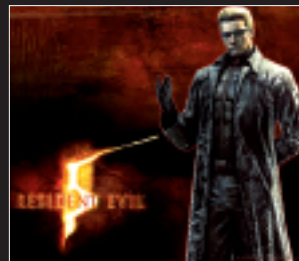
headstrong nineteen-year-old youth, able to warp time itself to her will!" Yeah, haven't heard that one before... Jokes apart, this sequel will give you the chance to customize your character as per gender, something that was previously not possible. Looking at the game trailers, this game looks to be another great hit from the Blizzard stables, and we are eagerly awaiting its release. You can learn more about the game at www.diablo3.com.

God Of War 3 (PS3)

Not much is known about the third and the final part of the *God of War* trilogy, but it will definitely be as exciting and as much fun as the previous two. The speculations we have for this game include new and more awesome weapons that kill and rend in even cooler ways. Can there ever be enough blood splatter? Surely not. The previous titles did a great job as action games, but we want more. We would especially like to see more of the Kratos character buildup — here's a person who can stand up to the very Gods, someone without fear... we love that aspect of his character and can't wait to see how the developers improve upon him. The story arc of the game so far is brilliant and going strong, we would definitely want to know more. There has also been speculation that *God of War III* will offer online gameplay, definitely something to look forward to... The *God of War III* website is http://www.us.playstation.com/PS3/Games/God_of_War_III/



Resident Evil 5 (PS3, Xbox 360)



Another sequel to another great franchise; but this game is also a movie series. *Resident Evil 5* continues in the same vein as its immediate successor. The game is similar to *Resident Evil 4* with the same 'over the shoulder' camera view. Instead of controlling the character of Leon, as done in the fourth game, you get to control Chris Redfield. While *RE:5* adds new weapons, it still retains the classic handguns and shotguns. Lighting plays an important part in this outing, with dark and bright environments offering drastically different styles of gameplay. For example: as Chris moves from a dark area to a brightly-lit area, the dilation of his pupils will cause you to see extended black instead of a direct readjustment of the environment around you. More human like behaviour has also been given to the enemies with

increased AI. And of course, this game introduces an element of co-operative multiplayer—you can either play locally over a split-screen, or remotely with your friends. Head to www.residentevil.com where you can find out more about this game.

Prototype (Xbox 360, PS3, PC)

Here's a rather challenging game for everybody. *Prototype* is a sandbox-style action game, which basically means you don't have to follow a single patch to reach your objective. You have the freedom to choose the way you want to play the game. Of course this freedom isn't without limit; you will have to follow the basic story outline which goes like this: You play Alex, a mutant shape-shifted with superhuman abilities of strength, speed, agility, durability and healing. You are also empowered with the abilities to consuming fallen enemies... a bit creepy, that. As we mentioned earlier, Alex can shape-shift and take on the guise of those he has consumed... getting creepier... Alex, of course, has lost his memory and is set out to regain it. He would also need to find his sister to get the answers he is looking for. The game throws two types of enemies at you: one is a set of humans that have been infected with a virus causing them to mutate, and the other are the special squad of soldiers sent out to kill the aforementioned mutants. The most interesting aspect is the shape-shifting ability, a new concept as a mean of destruction. We do hope that the gameplay is not overly complicated due to this mechanic. Radical (the developers behind this titles) claim that there are 750 different combinations that can be used through this power, so we hope they don't disappoint us. Head to www.prototypegame.com to learn more about the game.



inFAMOUS (PS3)

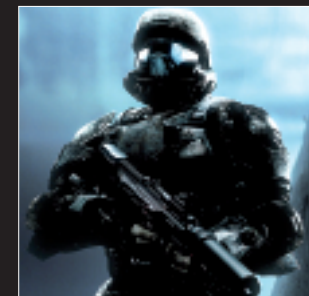
You play a college dropout named Cole, who is a bicycle messenger. One day Cole delivers a package which for some strange reason, causes a massive electromagnetic explosion that kills everybody in a six-block radius, except Cole. Cole is not the same after the explosion and now has super powers (he can control electricity) and is out for revenge, or more likely, an answer. While the setup sounds a bit overdone (remember the big green guy), the core gameplay seems interesting. Oh and did we mention that prior to the life-changing explosion Cole was athletic and knew parkour? Parkour, or free-running is getting quite common in the gaming world, with more and more games being created with parkour as the core concept. Another thing to watch out for is the sandbox style of gameplay offered by *inFAMOUS*



where you can choose to be either friendly by helping out people in distress, or just ignore them and do your own thing. Through its great graphic and cool powers, we hope that this new-age super hero game will be a win. Visit <http://www.suckerpunch.com/detail.php/games/infamous> for more about this game.

Halo 3: ODST (Xbox 360)

Formerly known as *Halo 3: Recon*, *ODST* is an expansion of *Halo 3*, created by Bungie. The gameplay is similar to the *Halo* trilogy but in this expansion you do not play as Master Chief, but rather a lone UNSC soldier in the city of New Mombasa, Kenya. You play a soldier of the Orbital Drop Shock Troopers (ODST) whose main objective is to find out what happened to his missing squad members. Since an ODST does not possess Master Chief's superhuman abilities and armor, he is more vulnerable to weapons fire, making for a more cautious and tactical gameplay. But don't get the wrong idea—*ODST* is not focused on stealth gameplay, however, some elements of stealth will be incorporated. To learn more about *Halo 3: ODST* head over to this web site www.bungie.net.



StarCraft II (PC, Mac OS X)

StarCraft II continues its epic saga where *StarCraft: Brood War* left off. *StarCraft II* will present a cast of new heroes and familiar faces in an edgy sci-fi story filled with adventure and intrigue. Protoss, Terran and Zerg, the three races in the game will be battling it out once again, only this time there will be new units, new abilities and new maps. *StarCraft* has always been one of the fastest RTS games around and be assured that this sequel will continue that aspect. This game caters to the veterans who love *StarCraft* and also to those who are new to the RTS genre. Blizzard will once again offer online play through Battle.net their online service, which is expected to offer new features to accommodate *StarCraft II*. Learn more about *Starcraft II* by visiting this web site: www.starcraft2.com.



Star Wars: The Old Republic (PC)

This game is likely to attract a varied bunch of people: from gamers, to geeks, to Star Wars freaks. Firstly, the MMORPG world will want to get their hands on this massively multiplayer title. Then there will be those who have played and enjoyed either of the two *Knights of the Old Republic* games,